Wednesday, December 6

The IDF is considering the disbanding of the settler unit “Sfar Hamidbar” (Desert Frontier), which was set up some years ago, due to its being the source of repeated violence against Palestinians and left-wing activists.

The battle for Khan Yunis, the main city in the South of Gaza, is continuing. The war may drag on for weeks, if not more. Israel is trying to get at Yahya Sinwar and Mohammed Deif, the two top figures of Hamas in Gaza, so far without results. In the meantime, the civilian population is in dire straits, notwithstanding the aid daily reaching the enclave. For the time being, the US doesn’t lean too heavily on Israel, but how long will American support continue before the president pressures Netanyahu for operational limitations and especially on postwar arrangements?

Today Mahmoud Abbas, the old and corrupt head of the Palestinian Authority, announced that he was ready to take over the government of Gaza after the war. Netanyahu responded that this wouldn’t happen as long as he is prime minister.

We are not so far along yet. Netanyahu announced that Sinwar’s house had been taken, but Sinwar himself is in one of the tunnels. I wonder whether Hamas can be entirely eliminated; as long as it cannot fight or govern, we should be satisfied. Israel’s main task is not only to win this war in military terms, but to get a long-lasting peace. This will not necessarily imply Abbas’s governing of the enclave; there are other possible formulas, but it will mean a Palestinian state on the horizon. That necessarily means a change of government, without the extremists and without the man who called on them to save his own skin: Netanyahu.

Let me get back for a moment to antisemitism, the real stuff. A few weeks ago, I wrote that I had started my life under the cloud of antisemitism and that I would end it under the same cloud. Actually, this is absolutely not the same cloud, thank God. Let me get back to April 1939, when my parents and I arrived, as hounded Jews, in Paris from Prague, where I was born, and